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[Manual Payroll Check Guidance](#)

SOP NUMBER: SOP-OPSFIN-250

Manual Payroll Checks

This Standard Operating Procedure outlines the process that should be followed to control, issue, and approve a manual payroll check.

APPLICABILITY

All Owned & Operated Hotels (including Shared Service Centers supporting these hotels).

EXCLUSIONS/EXCEPTIONS

No exclusions.

MANUAL PAYROLL CHECK GUIDANCE

Manual payroll checks are allowed to rectify payroll processing errors such as incorrect rates, incorrect number of hours, etc.

Blank check stock must be maintained in a secure location such as a safe or locked filing cabinet that is controlled by someone other than the signatories and the Team Member responsible for payroll processing. A log must be maintained that includes to whom each check is issued, the date issued, the net amount for which it is issued, and the signature of the Team Member receiving the check.

- a. A manual payroll check should only be used when there is a payroll processing error that fails to compensate the Team Member correctly for wages earned. If the error is immaterial or the Team Member is willing to wait until the next payroll cycle, then it is acceptable to do so.
- b. If a Team Member loses a check and requests a new check, then it must be processed during the next check run and only after it has been determined it has not cleared the bank. Each situation must be reviewed to determine if the current check must be voided and reissued or if a new check only needs to be issued. In some instances, a stop payment must be issued to the bank if the original check is not in custody.
- c. When it has been determined that a manual check needs to be issued, then the payroll Team Member will gather all the information required, fill out the relevant advance forms and obtain approval from the Human Resources Leader. The hotel must follow all payroll procedures as outlined in FP-OPSFIN-150 Payroll Controls.
- d. It is the responsibility of the payroll Team Member to ensure that the check is properly documented, calculated and input into the payroll system. Someone other than the payroll Team Member should approve the request, sign the check, and distribute to the Team Member.
- e. All manual checks or voided checks must be input into the payroll system during the current payroll cycle, or if between cycles, immediately after the new cycle begins. Under no circumstance can a manual check or voided check be delayed from being entered into the system.
- f. At month end, all manual checks must be reconciled to the log to ensure that all checks have been issued. The reconciliation should be forwarded to the Finance Leader.